EARLY YEARS EDUCATOR · LEARNING DESIGNER

Wei Ting *Chang*

(Murphy)

Inquiry, play and STEAM for children aged 1–6.



Teaching Portfolio 2026 · Prepared for applications in Singapore

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Where to *begin.*

Every line is a link.

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ABOUT ME

Profile and *experience.*

EXPERIENCE

5+ years

with children aged 1–6, and 50+ parent-child workshops

EDUCATION

B.S. Child and Family Studies

Fu Jen Catholic University, 2019

WORK IN SINGAPORE

LTVP & PLOC holder

No sponsorship required

LANGUAGES

Mandarin native · the language I teach in

English working proficiency

ECDA CERTIFICATION

Application ready

documents prepared; my employer submits the application

EXPERIENCE

2018–2022

Curriculum Designer & Lead Instructor
3X3 Education Group, Taipei (part-time)

Developed and taught hands-on programmes in creative arts, sensory exploration and inquiry.

2022–2024

Lead Teacher
Non-profit kindergarten at Wanlong Camp, Taipei
國防部軍備局萬隆營區職場互助教保服務中心

Led a class of **16 two-year-olds** with two educators and a **mixed-age class of 20** (ages 2–6): planning, routines, assessment and family communication.

2024–2026

Co-founder & Lead Educator
Wind Lab, Zhubei

Ran two programmes: a small-class, full-day classroom for ages 1–4, and weekend workshops for children and parents.

HOW I TEACH

Learning begins *with attention.*

I try to notice before I step in. Before I give an answer, I leave room for a question, a material or some time.

1 Start from children's questions.

A theme follows the children's questions and what they see every day, not a fixed plan.

IN PRACTICE

A child noticed a new supermarket, so we changed the route of our community walk.

2 Plan more than one way in.

I set up several ways to join in: touching and tasting, explaining and recording, or taking a role. Younger and older, bold and quiet children each find a place.

IN PRACTICE

In my mixed-age class of 20, the fruit theme offered tasting, walking, drawing and comparing. Each child could start where they felt comfortable.

3 Let children test, repair and revise.

I add a condition or a material, then step back. Children find what does not work and mend it themselves.

IN PRACTICE

Wobbly wheels on a balloon car were found in test runs and repaired by the children.

4 Revise my own plans.

After each theme I write down what I would change.

IN PRACTICE

My weekly logs showed too little child-initiated play, so I would extend each theme into the learning areas.

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PART 1

In the classroom

Non-profit kindergarten at Wanlong Camp, Taipei · 2022–2024

國防部軍備局萬隆營區職場互助教保服務中心

As lead teacher, working in Mandarin, I designed a curriculum theme and kept records of what children did and said.

IN THIS PART

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DESIGNING A CURRICULUM THEME

How Do We Know a *Fruit?*

Wanlong Camp kindergarten, Taipei · six-month theme with a mixed-age class of 20, ages 2–6









Washing apples · pressing apple slices · a watermelon face · fresh and dried fruit.

It began with a child-sized question: is a tomato a fruit or a vegetable?

WHAT I DID

Planned four periods around real materials: tasting, a community walk, opening unfamiliar fruit and making dried fruit. Each week I wrote a log of indicators, activities, children's words and my reflection.

WHAT CHILDREN SHOWED

Children offered size, seeds and taste as ways to decide. One child's remark about a new supermarket changed our route. Some moved from "I like it" to richer words such as sweet, sour and soft.

ORAL LANGUAGE

WHAT I WOULD CHANGE

My weekly logs showed too little child-initiated play, so I would extend the theme into the learning areas.

NOTICING AND ASSESSING

I record what children *do and say.*

Wanlong Camp kindergarten, Taipei · mixed-age class of 20, ages 2–6

Then I use it to decide what comes next.

WEEKLY LOG	Indicators, activities, children's own words, support given, and a reflection before, during and after each lesson.
THEME ASSESSMENT	Baseline in March, end check in June. Twelve indicators, four levels (independent to developing), a comment and photo for each child.
FAMILY RECORD	Ratings and my written note go home with space for parents to reply.

IN SINGAPORE'S TERMS · NEL FRAMEWORK

Fine-motor skills, healthy habits	**Health, Safety & Motor Skills Development**
Describing, taking turns to speak	**Language & Literacy**
Classifying, solving problems in groups	**Discovery of the World · Numeracy**
Exploring materials and light	**Aesthetics & Creative Expression**
Feelings, teamwork, gratitude	**Social & Emotional Competencies, across all areas**

My records use Taiwan's six domains, so this mapping is indicative. NEL is written for ages 4–6.

FOR CHILDREN UNDER THREE · ECDA'S EYDF

ECDA's Early Years Development Framework (2023) covers birth to three in four areas: cognitive, communication and language, physical, and social and emotional. My weekly records use one cycle at any age. I observe, write down what the child did, and plan the next experience from it.

PART 2

Wind Lab

A learning studio I co-founded in Zhubei · 2024–2026

Wind Lab ran two programmes. In the weekend workshops, I designed and taught STEAM sessions. In the full-day classroom for ages 1–4 (4 children, 2 adults), I taught every day, talked with families and ran a parent workshop.

IN THIS PART

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A STEAM investigation, ages 3–6 — 09

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FACILITATING INQUIRY

When Air Becomes *Motion*

Wind Lab weekend workshop, Zhubei · ages 3–6 · a children-only session, no parents



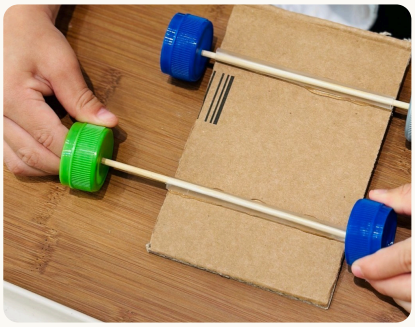
Pumping air into the balloon engine.



First guesses: blowing, pushing.



Making air visible: a tissue.



Building the axle: wheels on skewers.

Children proposed pushing and blowing. I tested their ideas, then added one condition: without touching it.

WHAT I DID

Made air visible with tissue, pumps and balloons before introducing the balloon engine. Left time to build, test and come back.

WHAT CHILDREN SHOWED

Two axle designs of their own. Wobbly wheels showed up in test runs and the children repaired them.

WORKING WITH PARENTS

Positive Discipline Starts with *Understanding*

Wind Lab · for parents of the full-day classroom · five parents · 4 January 2025

I facilitated this as a Certified Positive Discipline Early Childhood Education Facilitator (2024).



The workshop in progress. No children identified.

Parents arrived with questions. Is positive discipline unlimited freedom? Does it mean we cannot say no? What do I do when my child keeps not responding?

WHAT I DID

Built the two hours around caregivers' own questions: open questions, small groups, then role-play as caregiver and child.

WHAT PARTICIPANTS SHOWED

They began to read behaviour as a need, and saw that positive discipline is not constant positivity. When emotions came up, we talked about how hard caregiving is.

FULL-DAY CLASSROOM

The learning *environment.*

Wind Lab, Zhubei · small-class, full-day classroom · 4 children, 2 adults · ages 1–4

A room where children aged 1–4 can reach what they want and choose for themselves.



Open shelves of trays and materials, a book corner and round tables



A role-play kitchen and a tea table

REACHABLE	Materials sit on open shelves at children's height.
READY FOR SMALL GROUPS	Round tables and floor space suit a small class.
ROOM FOR PRETEND PLAY	A kitchen and tea set invite role-play and talk.

FULL-DAY CLASSROOM

Learning *through play.*

Wind Lab, Zhubei · ages 1–4 · sensory, science and looking closely



Shapes in light and shadow



Pouring and colour mixing



Homemade cloud sand



Shapes on a light table



Colour and mark-making

Photographs are shared with the consent of the children's parents.

FULL-DAY CLASSROOM

Making and playing *together.*

Wind Lab, Zhubei · ages 1–4 · making, moving and playing alongside others



Painting a cardboard house together



Rolling car wheels to paint



Building a track together



Painting at a shared table



Shaping dough

Photographs are shared with the consent of the children's parents.

FULL-DAY CLASSROOM

What families *saw.*

Wind Lab, Zhubei · small-class, full-day classroom · ages 1–4

Parents described changes they saw at home.

INDEPENDENCE	Children dressed themselves, opened their water bottles and managed routines with growing confidence.
EXPRESSION · ORAL LANGUAGE	One child moved from a few words to narrating the day, and found it easier to regulate emotions through language.
COURAGE TO TRY	A child who found unfamiliar outdoor places difficult became more willing to explore.

> "Whenever Murphy spoke about children, her eyes lit up. She was thoughtful, attentive and deeply committed to education."

A parent of the full-day classroom · translated from Chinese · anonymous

Selected from parent surveys. They describe the whole Wind Lab team's work, not mine alone.

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PART 3

Learning and writing

The training and thinking behind my practice

My certifications, and three short field notes on questions I keep coming back to.

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CERTIFICATIONS

What I *learned.*



STEAM Teaching for Tomorrow's Innovators

University of San Diego, Professional and Continuing Education · 3 February 2026

- Creativity: classroom conditions and strategies for divergent thinking
- Technology: digital tools for communication, documentation and collaboration
- SEL in STEAM: activities that support social-emotional learning and inclusion
- UDL: curriculum with a low floor and high ceiling for learners of different languages, cultures and abilities



Certified Positive Discipline Early Childhood Education Facilitator

Taipei · 2–4 August 2024 · facilitated by Justine Yao, CPDLT

- Belonging and significance through contribution and mutual respect
- How young children learn, and adapting teaching to them
- Understanding behaviour and guiding it in groups
- Class meetings, and Adlerian concepts for classroom and parents



Brick-by-Brick® Certified Facilitator

Play Included, a LEGO Foundation partner · 10 October 2024 · 8 CPD hours

- Learning through play and social-emotional development
- Insights from autistic consultants on neurodiversity
- Playful facilitation that sparks social interaction
- Running Brick Clubs for children with diverse needs

I use its play-based approach when I help children express their feelings and join in with others.

WRITING AND REFLECTIONS

Questions I *keep returning to.*

Field notes on early years inquiry, STEAM and responsive teaching.



Wei Ting Chang
Field note · STEAM in early childhood #01

Making the invisible visible

How can an invisible force become something a child can feel?

Before giving children the word for air, I asked what they thought air could do and offered plastic bags. Pressing and stepping on the sealed bags, they felt the air push back.

We then moved on to rocket tests. A launch that did not work gave us a reason to stop and look again.

INQUIRY · STEAM · SEL

Read on my website ↗



Wei Ting Chang
Field note · STEAM in early childhood #02

Thinking like a scientist

What changes when a prediction meets water?

After each test, I asked what the children noticed and whether it changed their thinking. Building boats from sponge pads and skewers, one said: “Maybe we need a bigger base.”

Some boats tilted and some sank. The children changed the design and tried again.

PREDICTION · INQUIRY · DESIGN

Read on my website ↗



Wei Ting Chang
Field note · STEAM in early childhood #03

Why sensory experience comes first

What needs to happen before an idea can make sense?

With children aged two to four, I see them look first, then reach out to touch. So we explore air with bags and balloons before anyone explains it.

When a child guesses that something will float, I say let’s try. The conversation starts there.

EARLY YEARS · STEAM · PLAY-BASED LEARNING

Read on my website ↗

CONTACT

Let's *talk.*

I am looking for early years teaching and learning-design roles in Singapore, in Mandarin-language or bilingual classrooms. I am happy to talk through any page of this portfolio.

LTVP & PLOC holder · **No sponsorship required**

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References available on request.

